

GIMP for Beginners, Part 5



'Isolation'

Welcome to the fifth instalment of the GIMP tutorials. Here we will unravel the major functions of selection tools, with a particular focus on Isolation.

*I*solation is the crucial tool part of image editing and is handy when you play around with an image. Each selection tool comes in use while isolating on different parts of an image. So what exactly is Isolation? Generally, it extracts/isolates a relevant part from an image for further use as another image. In this tutorial, we will be focusing on isolating images using various tools.

You should find the raw materials at www.linuxforu.com/gimptutorial/part5.tar.gz, and experiment with them using the methods mentioned. To ease the learning process, we will go through every possible isolation, one by one, using different tools and methods. Thus, I have segregated the tutorial into different parts:

- Isolating using the Rectangle selection
- Isolating using the Ellipse selection
- Isolating using the Free/Lasso selection
- Isolating using the Path selection
- Isolating using the Fuzzy/Colour selection



Note: We generally use corresponding tools for the various shapes and natures. However, this doesn't limit us to use, experience, and experiment with other tools to isolate non-relevant shapes. For instance, we normally use the Rectangle and Ellipse selection to isolate rectangles/squares and ellipses, though the applications are not limited to them alone. We can always use the Lasso/Free selection tool or the Path tool to isolate a part, irrespective of its shape and nature. That's why Path tools are generally called the universal selection tool as we can realise almost all the other selection tools with it.

Isolating images using the Rectangle/ Ellipse selection

Isolating images using the rectangular and the ellipse selection tools is the easiest of them all. In fact, authors writing for various technology magazines will find these tools a great boon. Isolating the relevant part increases the visible spectrum and thus makes the image more pronounced and